

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 6 3
 ♥ Q J 10 7
 ♦ 8 5 2
 ♣ 8 3

♠ J 8

♥ 9 6 2

♦ K Q 10 9 4

♣ 9 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 10 5 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ A 7 3

♣ J 6 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ A K 4

♦ J 6

♣ A K Q 10 4

West	North	East	South
			2NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥Q

played the ♦2, a low card signaling that he held an ODD number of ♦s. ODD must be either one or three so when he followed to the next ♦ you know he started with three. A little bit of counting tells you that South started with the doubleton Jack, so you want to win the second ♦ trick.

[showcards S:DJ W:D2 N:D4]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥Q, you played low and South won the ♥A.

South now plays the ♦J on which West plays the ♦2. What do you play now, and what is your plan.

Play the ♦3 and when South plays another ♦ win with your ♦A.

North hoped his ♦ suit would provide enough tricks to make the game. You can see that there is no entry to the North hand EXCEPT in ♦s, so you want to win your ♦A on the trick that South plays his last ♦. How can you tell which trick that is?

Only by watching what West plays. On the ♦J West played the ♦2, a low card signaling that he held an ODD number of ♦s. ODD must be either one or three so when he followed to the next ♦ you know he started with three. A little bit of counting tells you that South started with the doubleton Jack, so you want to win the second ♦ trick.

This defense holds South to one ♦ tricks, if you had let him win the second one he would have had 9 tricks.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 6 5
 ♥ Q 10 6 4
 ♦ K 7 2
 ♣ 10 5 2

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 8 7

♦ Q 6 5

♣ 9 7 6 4



♠ 8 7 2

♥ J 9 5 2

♦ A 8 4 3

♣ 8 3

♠ J 10 4

♥ A K 3

♦ J 10 9

♣ A K Q J

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥ 4			

[showcards S:ST]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥ 4, East plays the ♥ J, won by South with ♥ A.

South plays the ♠ J, you follow with ♠ 5, dummy ♠ 3 and East plays the ♠ 2. South continues with the ♠ 10

Play the ♠ 6.

East's ♠ 2 tells you he had an ODD number of ♠ s, obviously 3. Since South also must have 3, you must take your ♠ A on the third round, depriving dummy of the extra ♠ trick.

South may now turn to the ♦ suit, but your side can win the first ♦ and drive out South's ♥ K. You will win 2 ♥ s, 2 ♦ s and the ♠ A, down 1

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 4
 ♥ A 8 7 5 2
 ♦ 7 5 2
 ♣ 6 4 2

♠ K J 6

♥ J 10 6 3

♦ A Q 6

♣ Q 10 5



♠ 9 7 3 2

♥ -

♦ 10 9 8 4 3

♣ A K J 9

♠ A Q 10 5

♥ K Q 9 4

♦ K J

♣ 8 7 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥5

♥A and he can see that you don't want him to lead a ♠ or a ♦. He deduces that you might like a ♣ so he plays his ♣2 and you win 4 tricks.

[showcards W:H5 N:HT]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥5, dummy played the ♥10

Play the ♦3 (or the ♠2).

You really want West to lead a ♣ if he gets into the lead. If you discard the ♣9 West will surely get the message and will lead a ♣. BUT - you will only win 3 ♣ tricks. The ♣9 would have been the fourth winner.

So instead, play a low card in one of the other suits, say the ♦3.

South is one trick short and he sees he can easily get that trick in ♥s. So he plays a second ♥ from dummy and you now discard the ♠2. West takes the

He deduces that you might like a ♣ so he

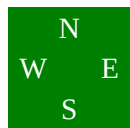
Board 4

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 5 3
 ♥ 4
 ♦ J 8 6 4 2
 ♣ J 9 4 3

♠ K J 7
 ♥ Q J 2
 ♦ Q 10 3
 ♣ K 10 7 5



♠ 8
 ♥ A 10 9 7 6 3
 ♦ 9 7 5
 ♣ A 6 2

♠ A Q 10 9 4 2
 ♥ K 8 5
 ♦ A K
 ♣ Q 8

West	North	East	South
		2♥	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♥4			

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥4, East takes the ♥A and returns the ♥3. You ruff and then play what???

Play a low ♣.

Partner played the ♥3, a low card, for you to ruff. That means his re-entry, if he has one, is in the lower-ranking suit.

Partner takes the ♣A and gives you a second ♥ ruff.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 6 3

♥ 10 6

♦ A K 8 4

♣ 8 7 2

♠ K Q 7 5 2

♥ Q 4

♦ 9 6 3

♣ K 9 6



♠ 10 9 4

♥ 9 5 3

♦ Q 7 2

♣ A Q J 4

♠ A

♥ A K J 8 7 2

♦ J 10 5

♣ 10 5 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♥

All Pass

2 ♥ by South

Lead: ♦ A

cash another ♣, then cash your ♦ Q. That first signal led to your side winning the first 6 tricks. Wow.

[showcards W:DA N:D3]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♦ A, dummy played the ♦ 3

Play the ♦ 2.

You know partner also has the ♦ K, and normally you would give an encouraging signal when you hold the Queen. But with this hand you want partner to switch to ♣s as soon as possible. So you play a low ♦.

West looks at your signal, then looks at dummy, then looks at your signal. He knows you want a switch and it looks like a switch to ♣s might work the best. South plays a low ♣ from dummy, you win the ♣ J. Next you play a low ♦, taken by West with his ♦ K. West leads a ♣. Dummy plays the ♣ K, you win that.

Board 6

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 6 4
♥ A K 7 2
♦ A 8 6 3
♣ 9 5

♠ A 10 3

♥ 10 6

♦ 9 7 2

♣ K Q J 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8

♥ Q J 8 4 3

♦ Q J 10 4

♣ 8 7 6

♠ K Q J 7 5 2

♥ 9 5

♦ K 5

♣ A 10 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ A			

[showcards W:HA E:HQ S:H5 N:H6]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥ A, East puts on the ♥ Q. It's your play.

Play the ♥ 2.

East's ♥ Q is either a singleton, (practically impossible), or a signal showing that he also holds the ♥ J. In either case you can reach the East hand on the second trick by playing a low ♥. Since you don't particularly want to start playing ♦ s from your side, you go ahead and play a small ♥, won by East with the ♥ J.

East next plays the ♦ Q and however South tries it your side will take the next two ♦ tricks and set the contract.